About Hurricanes and Other Tropical Storms

For Everyone

AUG. 26, 2026, VISIT LINK FOR DETAILS.

ESPAÑOL

KEY POINTS

- Hurricane season starts on May 15 in the north Pacific and June 1 in the Atlantic and the Caribbean. It ends on November 30.
- Know what to do to keep yourself and your loved ones safe before, during, and after the storm.

MORE INFORMATION

Be prepared for hurricanes



Before hurricane season each year, make sure you and your family are prepared by planning ahead.

Hurricane season starts on May 15 in the north Pacific and June 1 in the Atlantic and the Caribbean.

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KEEP READINGPreparing for Hurricanes or Other Tropical Storms

Stay safe after the storm



Know how to protect yourself and your loved ones after a hurricane or tropical storm. The storm might be over, but that doesn't mean the danger is. Keep yourself and your loved ones safe after the storm by following our safety tips.

KEEP READINGSafety Guidelines: After a Hurricane or Other Tropical Storm

Resources

- Natural Disasters and Severe Weather
- Floods and Your Safety
- Preparedness and Safety Messaging for Hurricanes, Flooding, and Similar Disasters (Second Edition | 2022)
- Hurricanes | Ready.gov
- Hurricane Preparedness | Red Cross

- National Hurricane Center (noaa.gov)

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For Everyone

MAY 28, 2026, VISIT LINK FOR DETAILS.

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KEY POINTS

- Get ready for hurricane season by making a plan, gathering supplies, and getting your home, car, and family ready for a storm.
- Know what you should do if you are told to evacuate or stay at home.

Get ready for hurricane season



Before hurricane season each year, make sure you and your family are prepared by planning ahead.

Hurricane season starts on May 15 in the north Pacific and June 1 in the Atlantic and the Caribbean. It ends on November 30.

Hurricanes don't only affect people living along the coast. They can cause damage hundreds of miles from the shore. Learn how to be prepared.

Make a plan.

Before hurricane season each year, make sure you and your family are prepared by planning ahead.

- Write down emergency phone numbers and keep them on the refrigerator or near every phone in your house. Program them into your cell phone too.
- Prepare an emergency supply kit.

- Locate the nearest shelter and different routes you can take to get there from your home. If shelter locations in your area have not been identified, learn how to find them in the event of a storm.
- Pet owners: Pre-identify shelters, a pet-friendly hotel, or an out-of-town friend or relative where you can take your pets in an evacuation. Local animal shelters may be able to offer advice on what to do with your pets if you are asked to evacuate your home.

Know the difference between a hurricane "watch" and "warning."

Listen for National Weather Service alerts on TV or radio or check for them online. There are two kinds of alerts:

- A **hurricane watch** means hurricane conditions (sustained winds of 74 miles per hour [mph] or higher) are **possible** in a stated area. Experts announce hurricane watches 48 hours before they expect tropical-storm-force winds (sustained winds of 39 to 73 mph) to start.

- A **hurricane warning** is more serious. It means hurricane-force winds are **expected** in a stated area. Experts issue these warnings 36 hours before tropical-storm-force winds are expected in the area to give people enough time to prepare for the storm.

  For more information about hurricane watches and warnings, check out the National Weather Service's Hurricane Center. If you hear that there is a hurricane watch or warning in your area, you can take steps to get ready.

Gather emergency supplies.

During and after a hurricane, you may need supplies to keep your family safe and healthy. Remember that a hurricane could cut off your power and water supply. You also may not be able to drive because of damage to your car. Roads may be flooded or blocked.

That's why it's best to be prepared—stock up on everything you might need now. Be sure to prepare the following:

- An emergency food and water supply.
- An emergency medicine supply.
- Emergency power sources such as flashlights (don't forget extra batteries).
- Safety and personal items.
- Important documents, including medical documents, wills, passports, and personal identification.
- A fire extinguisher. Make sure your family knows where to find it and how to use it! Read the National Fire Protection Association's tips for using fire extinguishers.

Get your home ready.



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- Clear your yard. Make sure there's nothing that could blow around during the storm and damage your home. Move bikes, lawn furniture, grills, propane tanks, and building material inside or under shelter.
- Cover up windows and doors. Use storm shutters or nail pieces

of plywood to the outside window frames to protect your windows. This can help keep you safe from pieces of shattered glass.

- Be ready to turn off your power. If you see flooding, downed power lines, or you have to leave your home, switch your power off.
- Fill clean water containers with drinking water. You'll want to do this in case you lose your water supply during the storm. You can also fill up your sinks and bathtubs with water for washing.
- Check your carbon monoxide (CO) detector's battery to prevent CO poisoning.

Get your car ready.

Make sure your car is ready before the storm hits.

- Fill your car's gas tank.
- Move cars and trucks into your garage or under cover.
- Always keep an emergency kit in your car.
- Visit Ready.gov for information on how to prepare your car and what to include in your kit.

If you don't own a car, consider making plans with friends or family or call authorities to get a ride if you need to evacuate.

Get your family and pets ready.

- Go over your emergency plan with your family.
- Keep checking for updates about the storm. Watch TV, listen to the radio, or check online.
- Call the hospital, public health department, or the police about special needs. If you or a loved one is older or disabled and won't be able to leave quickly, get advice on what to do.
- Put pets and farm animals in a safe place. Read more about pet safety during an emergency.

Be ready to evacuate or stay at home

Always listen to authorities regarding whether you should evacuate or stay at home.

If a hurricane is coming, you may hear an order from authorities to evacuate (leave your home).

Never ignore an order to evacuate. Even sturdy, well-built houses may not hold up against a hurricane. Staying home to protect your property is not worth risking your health and safety.

You may hear an order to stay at home. If driving conditions are dangerous, staying at home might be safer than leaving.

If you need to evacuate:

- Grab your emergency supply kit and only take what you really need with you (cell phone, chargers, medicines, identification like a passport or license, and cash).
- Unplug your appliances. If you have time, turn off the gas, electricity, and water.
- Follow the roads that emergency workers recommend even if there's traffic. Other routes might be blocked or flooded. Never drive through flooded areas—cars and other vehicles can be swept away or may stall in just 6 inches of moving water.
- Contact your local emergency management office and ask if

they offer accommodations for owners and their pets. Learn more about evacuating with your pet.

If you need to stay home:

- Keep your emergency supply kit in a place you can easily access.
- Listen to the radio or TV for updates on the hurricane.
- Stay inside. Even if it looks calm, don't go outside. Wait until you hear or see an official message that the hurricane is over. Sometimes, weather gets calm in the middle of a storm but then quickly gets bad again.
- Stay away from windows—you could get hurt by pieces of broken glass or flying debris during a storm. Stay in a room with no windows, or go inside a closet.
- Be ready to leave. If emergency authorities order you to leave or if your home is damaged, you may need to go to a shelter or a neighbor's house.

Resources

- Natural Disasters and Severe Weather

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- Hurricane Preparedness | Red Cross
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